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fun fact

the first press release came out of a train crash

Raise It With Press Release

swipe →



28 october 1906

A train run by a Pennsylvania Railroad subsidiary plunged off a bridge in Atlantic City, USA. Railways then usually **kept reporters away** and said little about the cause.

Source: Billy Penn (2023); Museum of Public Relations

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ivy lee chose to speak first

Publicist Ivy Lee wrote the company's own statement, handed it to reporters and gave them access to the site.

Source: Billy Penn (2023); Museum of Public Relations

fun fact

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30.10.1906

the new york times printed it word for word

That statement is often called the first press release of modern public relations.

Source: Billy Penn (2023); Museum of Public Relations

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lessons that still work 120 years later

- Speak first, before someone else frames your story
- Facts beat claims
- Make the journalist's job easier: access, data, sources

fun fact

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the press release was born in a crisis. now it's built for growth.

1. Save it for your next team training
2. Tag a colleague who loves PR history

Source:
· Billy Penn, 2023
· Museum of Public Relations